14. Reading list

Ranked by how much each source would change how you write about the AI-native transition, weighted towards primary sources and against vendor material. One line each on why. Each track file has a longer track-specific list under "Sources worth reading in full".

Status in brackets: [read] means the page was fetched this session; [not opened] means the network blocked it and it is known only from search extracts, so reading it in full matters more.

Top 25

1. **Humlum and Vestergaard, "Large Language Models, Small Labor Market Effects", NBER w33777 (May 2025), plus the 2026 update.** The best-identified test of your thesis: wide adoption with employer encouragement, tiny measured effects. If you read one thing, read this. [not opened] https://econpapers.repec.org/RePEc:nbr:nberwo:33777
2. **RAND, "The Root Causes of Failure for AI Projects and How They Can Succeed" (Aug 2024).** The only non-vendor study of failure causes, and the best support for "nobody can describe the problem". Read the method limits too. [not opened] https://www.rand.org/pubs/research_reports/RRA2680-1.html
3. **Microsoft Work Trend Index 2026, "Agents, human agency and the opportunity for every organization".** Vendor, but the data contradict "people resist": people ready, systems not. [read] https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/agents-human-agency-and-the-opportunity-for-every-organization
4. **Hosseini and Lichtinger, "Generative AI as Seniority-Biased Technological Change" (May 2026 version).** Best-identified evidence of the junior-hiring effect, and the argument that firms cut in anticipation. [read] https://raw.githubusercontent.com/s-mahdihosseini/Website/b99fa2962dcc4c165bbc3c41dd283afa99c5ccfb/GenAI_SenBTC_May_2026.pdf
5. **Anthropic, "How AI agents shape experts' judgment calls" (Oct 2026).** RCT showing human oversight of agents is mostly deference. Essential if you sell "humans and agents together". [read] https://www.anthropic.com/research/agents-judgment-calls
6. **MIT NANDA, "The GenAI Divide: State of AI in Business 2025".** The most cited and most misread source in the field. Read the methodology page before ever using "95%". [not opened] https://mlq.ai/media/quarterly_decks/v0.1_State_of_AI_in_Business_2025_Report.pdf
7. **Federal Reserve, Small Business Credit Survey 2026 Report on Employer Firms.** The only large US small-firm survey that measures depth of AI integration and reasons for non-use. [not opened] https://www.fedsmallbusiness.org/2026-report-on-employer-firms
8. **ONS, "Artificial intelligence in UK businesses: 2023 to 2026" (July 2026).** Official breadth-vs-depth data, including micro firms. [not opened] https://www.ons.gov.uk/businessindustryandtrade/business/businessservices/articles/artificialintelligenceinukbusinesses/2023to2026
9. **Dillon, Jaffe, Immorlica, Stanton, "Shifting Work Patterns with Generative AI" (Microsoft Research).** 6,000-worker RCT showing individual work changes and coordinated work does not. The cleanest evidence for "transformation is the hard part". [read] https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/research/publication/shifting-work-patterns-with-generative-ai/

10. **Anthropic Economic Index, September 2025.** The best large-sample support for the shared-context idea ("constrained more by access to information"). Vendor; inferred, not measured. [read] https://www.anthropic.com/research/anthropic-economic-index-september-2025-report
11. **Gloaguen et al., "Evaluating AGENTS.md" (Feb 2026).** Controlled test of context files: LLM-generated ones hurt, human-written ones help a little. Directly relevant to Studio. [not opened] https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.11988
12. **CRMArena-Pro (Salesforce AI Research, 2025).** The most business-shaped agent benchmark: multi-turn success falls to about 35%. [not opened] https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.18878
13. **tau-bench paper and repository.** pass^k is the right way to talk about agent reliability in business processes. [read] https://arxiv.org/abs/2406.12045 and https://raw.githubusercontent.com/sierra-research/tau-bench/main/README.md
14. **Anthropic, "How AI is transforming work at Anthropic" (Dec 2025).** A rare inside view of an AI-native firm, including mentoring and collaboration costs. [read] https://www.anthropic.com/research/how-ai-is-transforming-work-at-anthropic
15. **Hughes, "Do 70 Per Cent of All Organizational Change Initiatives Really Fail?", Journal of Change Management (2011).** Retires the most-used change statistic. [not opened] https://research.brighton.ac.uk/en/publications/do-70-per-cent-of-all-organizational-change-initiatives-really-fa/
16. **Brynjolfsson, Rock and Syverson, "The Productivity J-Curve" (AEJ: Macro 2021).** The theory that best explains why transformation looks unprofitable at first. [not opened] https://www.aeaweb.org/doi/10.1257/mac.20180386
17. **Massenkoff and McCrory (Anthropic), "Labor market impacts of AI" (Mar 2026).** Clear null on unemployment with stated power; young-worker hiring signal. [read] https://www.anthropic.com/research/labor-market-impacts
18. **Brynjolfsson, Chandar, Chen, "Canaries in the Coal Mine?" August 2026 revision.** The most cited displacement dataset; read the revision, not the 2025 headlines. [not opened] https://digitaleconomy.stanford.edu/news/canariesaug26/
19. **Autor, Chin, Salomons, Seegmiller, "New Frontiers: The Origins and Content of New Work, 1940-2018" (QJE 2024).** Where new work comes from, and why augmentation vs automation decides which history repeats. [not opened] https://economics.mit.edu/sites/default/files/2026-04/New-Frontiers-QJE-v139%283%29-p1399-1465-Aug-2024.pdf
20. **Kasy and Lehner, "Employing the unemployed of Marienthal" (IZA DP 16088).** Direct test of what work gives people beyond income. Essential for "freedom to be more human". [not opened] https://docs.iza.org/dp16088.pdf
21. **Vivalt et al., OpenResearch unconditional cash study, NBER w32719.** What people actually did with money and time. [not opened] https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w32719/w32719.pdf
22. **Moffatt v. Air Canada, 2024 BCCRT 149.** Short ruling; the clearest statement that a company owns what its agent says. [not opened] https://www.canlii.org/en/bc/bccrt/doc/2024/2024bccrt149/2024bccrt149.html
23. **Census BTOS "AI Question Wording Updates" note.** Required before citing any US adoption trend across late 2025. [not opened] https://www.census.gov/hfp/btos/downloads/AI%20Question%20Wording%20Updates.pdf
24. **Ericsson, "Defining AI native" white paper.** The only maturity model built around the word, and it admits the term has no clear definition. Useful for positioning your own definition. [not opened] https://www.ericsson.com/en/reports-and-papers/white-papers/ai-native

25. **Gartner press release, 25 June 2025 (agentic AI cancellations and "agent washing").** Read it to see how thin the basis of a much-quoted forecast is. [not opened] https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-06-25-gartner-predicts-over-40-percent-of-agentic-ai-projects-will-be-canceled-by-end-of-2027

Next 10, by theme

- **Agents in production:** Anthropic, "Measuring AI agent autonomy in practice" (Feb 2026), the only large dataset on how people supervise agents. [read] https://www.anthropic.com/research/measuring-agent-autonomy
- **Teaming:** Dell'Acqua et al., "The Cybernetic Teammate" (NBER w33641, 2025), P&G field experiment. [not opened] https://www.nber.org/papers/w33641
- **Macro scepticism:** Acemoglu, "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI" (NBER w32487). [not opened] https://www.nber.org/papers/w32487
- **Developer productivity:** METR RCT (arXiv 2507.09089), with METR's 2026 redesign post. [not opened] https://arxiv.org/abs/2507.09089
- **Enterprise data reality:** Spider 2.0 (arXiv 2411.07763). [not opened] https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.07763
- **Public opinion:** Pew, "How the U.S. Public and AI Experts View Artificial Intelligence" (Apr 2025). [not opened] https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/2025/04/03/how-the-us-public-and-ai-experts-view-artificial-intelligence/
- **Trust vs use:** KPMG and University of Melbourne, "Trust, attitudes and use of AI: a global study 2025". [not opened] https://figshare.unimelb.edu.au/articles/report/Trust_attitudes_and_use_of_artificial_intelligence_A_global_study_2025/28822919
- **Clerical automation history:** Feigenbaum and Gross, "Answering the Call of Automation" (QJE 2024). [not opened] https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w28061/w28061.pdf
- **UK labour market:** Bank Underground, "Canaries in the column" (Aug 2026). [not opened] https://bankunderground.co.uk/2026/08/06/canaries-in-the-column-ai-exposure-and-the-uks-hiring-slowdown/
- **Counter-narrative on enterprise ROI:** Wharton/GBK "Accountable Acceleration" (2025). [not opened] https://knowledge.wharton.upenn.edu/special-report/2025-ai-adoption-report